
A PRACTICAL FIELD GUIDE FOR TALENT ACQUISITION TEAMS

Prompt *Engineering* for Recruiters

Thirteen prompting techniques, 10 lifecycle use-cases, blended prompt strategies, responsible AI guidelines, and a 30-day learning plan — built specifically for talent acquisition professionals.

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CHAPTER 1

Why Recruiters Need Prompt Engineering

Recruiting is a context-heavy profession. A recruiter is not simply moving resumes from one stage to another — they are translating business need into market language, reading between the lines of a job description, advising hiring managers, engaging candidates, and helping teams make better decisions under imperfect information.

AI can support that work, but it cannot guess the full context. When a recruiter types a vague prompt, the model fills in the blanks with generic assumptions. Sometimes those assumptions create poor candidate messaging, inaccurate resume summaries, unrealistic sourcing plans, or biased decision support.

Prompt engineering is the skill of directing AI clearly. It is less about clever words and more about giving the model the same guidance you would give a smart junior recruiter.

The Recruiter Advantage

Recruiters already know how to prompt *humans*. A strong hiring manager intake meeting is a prompt. A candidate screen is a prompt. A calibration meeting is a prompt. The same muscle works with AI — the difference is that AI responds literally and quickly, so the quality of your instruction matters even more.

× WEAK PROMPT

Write a candidate outreach message.

✓ STRONG PROMPT

Act as a senior technical recruiter. Write a warm, concise outreach message to a senior backend engineer with distributed systems experience. The role is remote and cloud-focused. Avoid hype. Keep it under 120 words. Sound human and respectful of the candidate's time.

What AI Can and Cannot Do in Hiring

AI CAN

- ✓ Draft, summarize, compare, restructure, brainstorm
- ✓ Review JDs for bias and unrealistic requirements

AI SHOULD NOT

- × Be treated as the final decision-maker in hiring
- × Invent evidence not present in the resume or notes

- ✓ Organize candidate evidence by competency
- ✓ Generate Boolean strings and outreach angles
- ✓ Turn metrics data into stakeholder narratives

- ✗ Replace recruiter judgment or stakeholder influence
- ✗ Produce output used without human review
- ✗ Handle confidential data without policy approval

PRACTICE EXERCISE

Rewrite this weak prompt: "Review *this resume*." Add role, task, context, output format, and success criteria. Suggested cue: *Act as a senior recruiter. Review this resume against the job description. Give strengths, gaps, risks, and recommended interview questions. Keep the analysis evidence-based and neutral.*

CHAPTER 2

The Anatomy of a Strong Recruiting Prompt

A strong prompt usually has seven parts. You don't need every part every time, but when the work matters, these elements help the AI produce an answer that's closer to what a recruiter actually needs.

ELEMENT	WHAT IT DOES	TA EXAMPLE
Role	Sets the professional perspective	Act as a senior technical recruiter.
Task	Defines the job to be done	Compare this resume against the JD.
Context	Provides essential background	Here are intake notes and must-have skills.
Audience	Shapes tone and depth	Write this for a VP of Engineering.
Constraints	Creates clear boundaries	Keep it under 150 words; avoid jargon.
Output Format	Controls how the answer is structured	Use a table: strengths, gaps, risks.
Success Criteria	Defines what good looks like	Help us decide whether to move forward.

THE REUSABLE MASTER FORMULA

MASTER TEMPLATE

Act as [role]. I need you to [task]. Here is the context: [context]. The audience is [audience]. Follow these constraints: [constraints]. Format the answer as [format]. The goal is [success criteria].

TA EXAMPLE – PRINCIPAL SOFTWARE ENGINEER REVIEW

Act as a senior technical recruiter. I need you to review this candidate for a Principal Software Engineer role. Here is the context: the JD, scorecard, and resume. The audience is the hiring manager. Keep the analysis concise, evidence-based, and neutral. Format the answer as strengths, gaps, risks, and recommended follow-up questions. The goal is to decide whether this candidate should move to the final round.

WHY STRUCTURE MATTERS

When you use a structured prompt, you're not just improving the AI response — you're improving your own thinking. You're deciding what the task is, what the relevant evidence is, who the answer is for, and what decision the output should support. Structured prompting forces clarity *before* the work begins.

CHAPTERS 3-15

The 13 Core Prompting Techniques

Each technique is a distinct tool with a distinct cue word. Use them alone for simple tasks. Blend two or three for complex, high-stakes recruiting work.

Role Prompting

"Act as..."

Sets the professional perspective. The same problem looks different to a sourcer, recruiter, HM, HRBP, or TA leader.

Audience Setting

"Write this for..."

Shapes tone and depth to match the receiver — candidate warmth vs. executive brevity.

Constraints

"In X words; avoid jargon"

Creates word count, tone, and compliance boundaries. Use when output is too long, fluffy, or casual.

Output Structure

"Use a table; format as..."

Controls how the answer is laid out. Essential for scorecards, candidate evaluations, and metrics.

Few-Shot Prompting

"Here are a few examples..."

Teaches the AI a pattern from your own past work — outreach voice, scorecard format, update style.

Context Priming

"Here is the background..."

Grounds the AI in JDs, intake notes, resumes, metrics, or stakeholder goals before it responds.

Chain of Thought

"Show me your work..."

Makes AI reasoning visible and inspectable. Critical for candidate comparison and offer decisions.

Clarifying Questions

"Ask me clarifying questions first"

Prevents bad assumptions. Makes the model pause and gather what a strong recruiter would ask for.

Iteration Prompting

"Refine this further..."

Shapes output over several rounds. The most realistic way to use AI — treat the first output as draft one.

Prompt Chaining

"First... then... finally..."

Breaks large tasks into reviewable steps. Prevents the AI from heading too far down the wrong path.

Error Correction

"That detail is incorrect; revise"

A critical safety skill. AI sounds confident while being wrong — point out the mistake, don't restart.

Persona Fusion

"Act as both..."

Surfaces how the same candidate looks through multiple stakeholder lenses. Exposes real tradeoffs.

Self-Consistency

"Consider multiple angles before concluding"

Pressure-tests a recommendation across multiple criteria — fit, compensation risk, growth, culture add — before committing to a single answer. Useful for candidate fit, vendor selection, and offer strategy.

CHAPTER 16

Applying Prompts Across the Recruiting Lifecycle

The strongest recruiter prompts are mapped to the actual recruiting lifecycle. This chapter shows how to apply techniques in practical situations — with prompt cues, realistic examples, AI-style outputs, and the exact points where a recruiter must validate with the hiring manager.

CORE PRINCIPLE

The goal is not to let AI run the recruiting process. The goal is to use AI as a structured thinking partner so the recruiter can ask better questions, reduce ambiguity, improve candidate experience, and operate as a true talent advisor.

01	HM Intake Preparation Context priming + clarifying questions + prompt chaining. AI helps prepare layered intake questions, identify vague requirements, and surface what's missing from the brief before you meet the hiring manager.
02	Job Description Review Persona fusion + constraints. AI reviews from both recruiting and hiring manager lenses — inflated requirements, biased language, missing selling points, and unrealistic skill combinations.
03	Sourcing Strategy Context priming + self-consistency + output structure. Turns a calibrated role into target titles, adjacent titles, Boolean strings, source companies, exclusion criteria, and outreach angles.
04	Candidate Outreach Few-shot + audience setting + constraints. Uses examples of your writing style to create specific, human outreach — not polished-but-generic AI voice. Passive candidates notice the difference.
05	Resume Review & Fit Analysis Context priming + chain of thought + evidence constraints. Separates direct evidence, possible evidence, gaps, risks, and screen questions. AI must not invent facts — ever.
06	Interview & Scorecard Design Persona fusion + prompt chaining. Creates competency-based questions, assigns interviewers, and builds debrief rubrics tied to actual role requirements — not generic interview guides.
07	Candidate Debrief Support

Self-consistency + output structure + error correction. Organizes feedback into evidence, themes, risks, and open questions. Flags vague interviewer feedback and asks for clarification.

08 Offer Strategy & Closing

Context priming + clarifying questions + self-consistency. Structures closing strategy across compensation, role scope, manager fit, growth path, and timing — never pressure tactics.

09 Recruiting Metrics & Reporting

Context priming + output structure + self-consistency. Turns funnel data into executive-ready insight: conversion, bottlenecks, source quality, candidate experience risk, and recommended actions.

10 Recruiter Performance Reviews

Context priming + few-shot + iteration. Maps work evidence to company behaviors and creates a specific, truthful mid-year narrative — not inflated, not generic, in the recruiter's own voice.

Lifecycle Prompts in Action

The following prompts can be dropped directly into a conversation. Replace bracketed text with real context before using.

1. HM INTAKE PREPARATION

INTAKE PROMPT

Act as both a senior technical recruiter and an engineering hiring manager. I am preparing for a hiring manager intake meeting. Use the role request below as context. First identify what is clear, then identify what is missing, then create intake questions grouped by: role scope, must-have skills, nice-to-have skills, success metrics, interview process, compensation risk, and selling points. Ask practical questions only. Keep the output recruiter-friendly.

Role request: [paste role request]

3. SOURCING STRATEGY

SOURCING PROMPT

Act as a senior technical sourcer and talent market advisor. Use the calibrated role context below. Create a sourcing strategy that includes target titles, adjacent titles, likely source companies, Boolean search strings, keywords to include, keywords to avoid, candidate selling points, and market risks. Consider multiple angles before concluding: skill fit, title variation, market availability, seniority calibration, and candidate motivation. Format the output as a recruiter-ready sourcing plan.

Context: [paste calibrated role details]

5. RESUME REVIEW & CANDIDATE FIT

RESUME REVIEW PROMPT

Act as a senior technical recruiter. Use the job description and resume below. Review the candidate for fit, but do not invent evidence. Show me your work by separating: direct evidence, possible evidence, gaps, risks, and follow-up questions. Format the output as a table with columns: requirement, evidence from resume, strength level, concern, and screen question. End with a recruiter recommendation: strong screen, possible screen, or do not screen.

Job description: [paste JD] Resume: [paste resume]

7. CANDIDATE DEBRIEF SUPPORT

DEBRIEF PROMPT

Act as a talent advisor facilitating a candidate debrief. Use the interview notes below. Consider multiple angles before concluding: technical fit, role scope, communication, leadership, growth potential, culture add, and risks. Do not make a hire/no-hire decision. Instead, summarize evidence, identify alignment and concerns, and list unresolved questions for the debrief. If any feedback is vague, flag it and suggest a clarification question.

Interview notes: [paste anonymized notes]

9. RECRUITING METRICS & STAKEHOLDER REPORTING

METRICS PROMPT

Act as a talent acquisition leader and recruiting operations analyst. Use the funnel report below. Analyze the data across multiple angles: volume, conversion, speed, quality signals, source effectiveness, candidate experience risk, and hiring manager bottlenecks. Format the output as executive summary, key insights, risks, recommended actions, and questions to validate. Do not overstate conclusions if the data is incomplete.

Report: [paste or upload metrics report]

Recruiter Validation Principle: For every AI output in this lifecycle, the recruiter must check whether the output is grounded in real evidence. If the AI states something that isn't supported by the resume, notes, or data — use error correction immediately: *"That detail is not supported. Revise the analysis using only evidence in the source material."*

CHAPTER 17

Blending Techniques Like a Talent Advisor

Real recruiting work rarely uses one technique at a time. A strong prompt often blends role, context, structure, examples, reasoning, and iteration. The goal is not to memorize technique names — it's to know which cues to combine for the job in front of you.

BLEND 1 — CANDIDATE COMPARISON

TECHNIQUES: CONTEXT PRIMING + CHAIN OF THOUGHT + ITERATION

Best when: comparing two finalists, preparing a hiring manager recommendation, or making a case for moving forward on a non-obvious candidate.

CANDIDATE COMPARISON BLEND

Act as a senior technical recruiter. Here is the JD, scorecard, and two resumes. Compare the candidates against the role. Show your work across must-have skills, scope, leadership, and risk. Recommend who should move forward. Then ask me what criteria I want to refine before producing a final hiring manager summary.

BLEND 2 — RECRUITING EMAIL

TECHNIQUES: FEW-SHOT + AUDIENCE SETTING + CONSTRAINTS

Best when: tone matters and you don't want generic AI voice. Passive candidates notice immediately if an outreach could apply to anyone.

OUTREACH EMAIL BLEND

Here are four examples of my candidate outreach emails. Learn my tone. Now write an outreach message for a senior data platform engineer. The audience is a passive candidate. Keep it under 120 words. Avoid buzzwords and make the first sentence specific to the candidate's background.

BLEND 3 — SOURCING STRATEGY FROM SCRATCH

TECHNIQUES: CLARIFYING QUESTIONS + PROMPT CHAINING

Best when: the request is vague or when a new role arrives without calibration. The AI gathers information before building anything.

VAGUE-ROLE SOURCING BLEND

Before answering, ask me clarifying questions about must-have skills, target companies, location, compensation, and timeline. After I answer, first create a role calibration summary, then a sourcing map, then Boolean strings, and finally outreach angles.

BLEND 4 — TA TOOL OR VENDOR EVALUATION

TECHNIQUES: PERSONA FUSION + SELF-CONSISTENCY

Best when: the answer must balance operational, technical, financial, and people considerations across multiple stakeholder views.

TOOL EVALUATION BLEND

Act as both a TA leader and an AI adoption advisor. Evaluate these two recruiting tools across cost, recruiter workflow fit, data privacy, adoption risk, reporting value, and candidate experience. Consider multiple angles before concluding.

CHAPTER 18

Prompt Templates for Recruiters

Templates save time, but should not become scripts you use blindly. A good template gives you a starting point — you still need to insert real context, check assumptions, and revise the output.

TEMPLATE 1 — HIRING MANAGER INTAKE GUIDE

Act as a senior talent advisor. I am preparing for a hiring manager intake meeting. Here is the role information: [paste JD or notes]. Ask clarifying questions first. Then create an intake guide with sections for business need, must-have skills, nice-to-have skills, success outcomes, target talent pools, compensation risks, interview plan, and open questions.

TEMPLATE 2 — JD REWRITE

Act as both a recruiter and candidate experience expert. Review this job description: [paste JD]. Identify unclear language, unrealistic requirements, biased or exclusionary wording, missing selling points, and marketability issues. Then rewrite it in plain language for the target candidate audience.

TEMPLATE 3 — BOOLEAN SEARCH BUILDER

Use the following role context: [paste context]. First identify must-have concepts and synonyms. Then create three Boolean strings: broad, balanced, and narrow. Explain what each string is optimized for.

TEMPLATE 4 — CANDIDATE OUTREACH

Here are a few examples of my outreach style: [paste examples]. Learn the tone and structure. Now write an outreach message for [candidate profile] about [role]. Keep it under [word count]. Make it specific, human, and low-pressure.

TEMPLATE 5 — RESUME REVIEW

Act as a senior recruiter. Compare this resume against the job description. Use only the evidence provided. Format the answer as strengths, gaps, risks, and interview questions. Show your work before making a recommendation.

TEMPLATE 6 — DEBRIEF SUMMARY

Here are interview notes and the scorecard. Summarize the evidence by competency. Highlight areas of agreement, conflicting signals, risks, and follow-up needed. Keep the tone neutral and evidence-based.

TEMPLATE 7 — RECRUITING METRICS INSIGHT

Act as a TA leader. Here are recruiting metrics for the period: [paste metrics]. Here are our success benchmarks: [paste benchmarks]. Analyze performance, identify trends, explain risks, and recommend three actions. Format for an executive audience.

TEMPLATE 8 — RECRUITER PERFORMANCE STORY

Here are company behaviors, performance expectations, and this recruiter's self-evaluation. Connect the evidence to the expectations. Draft a balanced performance narrative that highlights impact, growth, and specific examples. Keep it fair, specific, and manager-ready.

CHAPTER 19

Responsible AI in Hiring

Recruiting is a high-stakes function. AI output can influence who gets contacted, who gets interviewed, how candidates are evaluated, and what stakeholders believe. That means recruiters must use AI with discipline.

Do Not Let AI Invent Evidence

A model may infer things that are not stated. In hiring, that is dangerous. If a resume does not show people management experience, the AI should not say the candidate has it. If interview notes do not support a competency, the AI should not fill the gap with optimistic language.

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY CUE – ADD TO EVERY EVALUATION PROMPT

Use only the information provided. Do not infer or invent experience. If evidence is missing, say "not enough evidence."

The Four Non-Negotiable Rules

x	No ranking on personal traits unrelated to the job Keep all evaluations tied strictly to role-relevant competencies and documented evidence. Avoid prompts that ask the model to judge protected characteristics or personal background.
x	No final employment decisions without human review AI organizes evidence and surfaces questions. It does not replace recruiter judgment, hiring manager accountability, or legal review.
x	No confidential candidate data without policy approval Do not paste sensitive candidate information into AI tools unless your organization has approved the tool's data handling and privacy terms. Redact unnecessary personal data where possible.
x	No treating polished AI output as automatically correct AI can sound confident while being wrong. Review every output for accuracy, fairness, and business context before using it with candidates, hiring managers, or stakeholders.

Use only the provided resume and JD. Do not infer protected characteristics. Separate evidence from assumptions. If evidence is missing, say "not enough evidence" rather than filling the gap with inferred language.

CHAPTER 20

Building Your Prompt Playbook

A prompt playbook is a reusable library organized by workflow, reviewed regularly, and improved based on actual results — not a random folder of AI tricks.

HOW TO DOCUMENT EACH PROMPT

FIELD	WHAT TO CAPTURE
Prompt Name	Short identifier, e.g. "JD Review — Senior Tech Role"
Use Case	When exactly to use this prompt
Input Needed	JD, resume, scorecard, metrics, examples, etc.
Prompt Text	The reusable prompt with placeholders
Technique Used	Few-shot, context priming, chaining, etc.
Quality Check	How to verify the output before using it
Owner	Who maintains and updates this prompt

PROMPT TESTING CUE

Run this prompt on the same input three ways: concise, detailed, and executive-ready. Compare the outputs and tell me which version is most useful for a recruiter and why.

CHAPTER 21

The Future Recruiter

The future recruiter is not a person who sends more automated messages. They are a sharper talent advisor who uses AI to prepare better, personalize more thoughtfully, and analyze evidence faster.

WILL MATTER MORE

- Understanding business context
- Calibrating roles with hiring managers
- Building trust with candidates
- Interpreting market signals
- Using data without losing human judgment
- Communicating clearly with executives

WILL MATTER LESS

- Manual reformatting
- Starting every draft from scratch
- Generic candidate messaging
- Unstructured interview prep
- Copy-paste reporting
- Waiting for perfect info before drafting

YOUR 90-DAY GROWTH PROMPT

Act as a TA career coach and AI adoption advisor. Here is my current role, strengths, experience, and career goal. Ask me clarifying questions first. Then create a 90-day plan to help me become stronger at AI-enabled talent acquisition leadership.

Cue Word Cheat Sheet

A quick desk reference. The cue words are not magic spells — they are simple instructions that tell the AI what behavior you want. Blending two or three in one prompt is standard for real TA work.

TECHNIQUE	CUE WORD(S)	BEST RECRUITING USE
Role Prompting	Act as...	JD review, candidate outreach, resume analysis, stakeholder updates
Audience Setting	Write this for...	Candidate messages, HM updates, executive communications
Constraints	In X words; avoid jargon	Any output that's too long, fluffy, casual, or uncertain
Output Structure	Use a table; format as...	Scorecards, candidate evaluations, metrics summaries
Few-Shot Prompting	Here are a few examples...	Teaching your voice — outreach, summaries, executive updates
Context Priming	Here is the background...	Any task requiring JD, resume, intake notes, or metrics
Chain of Thought	Show me your work...	Candidate comparison, offer decisions, sourcing strategy
Clarifying Questions	Ask me clarifying questions first	Intake prep, sourcing strategy, JD rewrites
Iteration Prompting	Refine this further...	Shaping any first draft for tone, depth, and precision
Prompt Chaining	First... then... finally...	Complex tasks — sourcing plans, interview design, offer strategy
Error Correction	That detail is incorrect; revise	Any time AI states something factually wrong or unsupported
Persona Fusion	Act as both...	Resume reviews, tool evaluation, debrief facilitation
Self-Consistency	Consider multiple angles before concluding	Candidate fit, vendor selection, offer strategy, debrief support

THE BLENDED MASTER PROMPT

"Act as a senior technical recruiter. Here is the JD and resume. Show me your work. Use a table. Ask clarifying questions if evidence is missing. Refine this further for a hiring manager audience."

TERMS RECRUITERS SHOULD USE OFTEN

→ Use only the evidence provided.

→ Ask clarifying questions before answering.

→ Separate facts from assumptions.

→ Show me your work.

→ Consider multiple angles before concluding.

→ Refine this further for the audience.

30-Day Learning Plan

Prompt engineering becomes useful when it becomes a habit. At the end of 30 days, the goal is a working prompt playbook that saves time, improves clarity, and makes your recruiting stronger.

WEEK 1 — PROMPT BASICS		WEEK 3 — ANALYSIS & DECISION SUPPORT	
Day 1	Rewrite 5 weak prompts using role, task, and context	Day 15	Compare a resume to a JD using evidence boundaries
Day 2	Practice constraints: word count, tone, audience, format	Day 16	Ask the AI to show its work on a candidate review
Day 3	Create 3 role prompts: recruiter, sourcer, TA leader	Day 17	Create follow-up questions from identified gaps
Day 4	Convert one messy JD into a structured prompt	Day 18	Use self-consistency across multiple eval criteria
Day 5	Use output structure to create a scorecard table	Day 19	Correct an AI mistake and revise the output
Day 6	Review AI output for unsupported assumptions	Day 20	Summarize mock interview notes by competency
Day 7	Create your first personal prompt template	Day 21	Build a candidate debrief template
WEEK 2 — COMMUNICATION & STYLE		WEEK 4 — TA LEADERSHIP WORKFLOWS	
Day 8	Use few-shot prompting with your own outreach examples	Day 22	Analyze recruiting metrics against team benchmarks
Day 9	Draft 3 candidate messages for different seniority levels	Day 23	Create an executive update from metrics data
Day 10	Refine each message twice using iteration prompting	Day 24	Draft a hiring manager calibration memo
Day 11	Write for 3 audiences: candidate, HM, executive	Day 25	Build a sourcing strategy using prompt chaining
Day 12	Practice tone changes: warm, direct, executive-ready	Day 26	Create a recruiter performance narrative from evidence
Day 13	Create a rejection-message improvement prompt	Day 27	Build a reusable prompt library organized by workflow

Day 14	Add the best prompts to your playbook
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Day 28	Test prompts with 3 real, approved recruiting scenarios
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Day 29	Remove weak prompts from your library
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Day 30	Teach one colleague the cue-word cheat sheet
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Prompt Engineering Cheat Sheet

Techniques · Trigger Cues · Talent Acquisition Examples

1 Constraints

Set clear limits so AI stays focused and concise.

CUE

"In 120 words" · "Use simple language" · "Avoid jargon"

TA EXAMPLE

Draft a candidate outreach email for a backend engineer.

2 Output Structure

Control the shape of the answer so it is easy to use.

CUE

"Give me 5 clear steps"

TA EXAMPLE

Explain how to run a kickoff intake meeting in 5 steps.

3 Role / Persona

Give the AI a professional lens for its answer.

CUE

"Act as a senior TA manager"

TA EXAMPLE

Review this hiring plan as a TA leader.

4 Few-Shot

Teach AI your style by sharing examples of past work.

CUE

"Here are a few examples"

TA EXAMPLE

Learn my recruiter email style and write a new outreach note.

5 Context Priming

Load the AI with background before asking the question.

CUE

"Here is the JD, scorecard, and team goals"

TA EXAMPLE

Compare candidates using our hiring criteria.

6 Chain of Thought

Make AI show its reasoning so you can inspect it.

CUE

"Think step-by-step" · "Show me your work"

TA EXAMPLE

Explain why candidate A is a better fit than candidate B.

7 Clarifying Questions

Make AI pause and gather missing info before answering.

CUE

"Ask clarifying questions before answering"

TA EXAMPLE

Before building a sourcing strategy, ask what success looks like.

8 Persona Fusion

Combine two lenses in one answer to expose tradeoffs.

CUE

"Act as both a TA leader and an AI advisor"

TA EXAMPLE

Suggest how AI can improve recruiting operations.

9 Iteration

Refine AI output over rounds. First draft is draft one.

CUE

"Refine this further"

TA EXAMPLE

Improve this resume summary for a principal recruiter role.

10 Prompt Chaining

Break large tasks into sequential, reviewable steps.

CUE

"First... then... finally..."

TA EXAMPLE

Draft a base resume, tailor it to a JD, then write a cover note.

11 Error Correction

Point out AI mistakes directly. Do not restart from scratch.

CUE

"That detail is wrong; correct it"

TA EXAMPLE

12 Self-Consistency

Pressure-test the answer across multiple dimensions.

CUE

"Consider multiple angles"

TA EXAMPLE



You used the wrong headcount target
— fix the analysis.

Evaluate a candidate across skills,
culture add, growth, and stakeholder
fit.



BLEND TECHNIQUES

Common combo: Context Priming → Few-Shot → Chain of Thought → Iteration

Recruiter Prompt Playbook

A sample from the full 75-prompt playbook, organized by recruiting stage. Each entry includes the technique blend, trigger cues, and a copy-paste template.

ROLE INTAKE & CALIBRATION

ID	USE CASE	TECHNIQUE BLEND	COPY / PASTE PROMPT TEMPLATE
RP-001	Prepare for HM intake meeting	Persona fusion + clarifying questions	Act as both a senior recruiter and a hiring manager. I am preparing for an intake meeting for [ROLE]. Here is the context: [PASTE CONTEXT]. Ask clarifying questions about must-haves, nice-to-haves, level, comp, process, and urgency.
RP-002	Convert vague HM needs into requirements	Context priming + constraints	Act as a talent advisor. Convert the following HM notes into recruiter-ready requirements. Separate must-haves, nice-to-haves, disqualifiers, success outcomes, and open questions. Notes: [PASTE NOTES].
RP-003	Identify inflated requirements	Persona fusion + self-consistency	Act as both a senior recruiter and a hiring manager. Review this JD for inflated requirements. Consider market availability, level alignment, comp realism, and candidate appeal before concluding. JD: [PASTE JD].
RP-005	Create a role calibration summary	Prompt chaining	First summarize the role in plain language. Then identify must-haves, nice-to-haves, target profiles, and selling points. Finally create a one-page calibration summary for [ROLE]: [PASTE CONTEXT].

SOURCING STRATEGY

ID	USE CASE	TECHNIQUE BLEND	COPY / PASTE PROMPT TEMPLATE
RP-011	Build a sourcing strategy	Context priming + prompt chaining	Act as a senior sourcer. Here is the role context: <i>[PASTE CONTEXT]</i> . First summarize the target profile. Then recommend target companies, titles, Boolean keywords, exclusions, and outreach angles. Finally list assumptions to validate.
RP-012	Generate Boolean search strings	Constraints + output structure	Act as a technical sourcer. Create Boolean strings for <i>[ROLE]</i> using these must-have skills: <i>[SKILLS]</i> . Provide one broad, one balanced, and one narrow string. Explain when to use each.
RP-015	Improve a poor sourcing search	Error correction + iteration	My current search string is returning <i>[TOO MANY/TOO FEW/IRRELEVANT]</i> results. String: <i>[PASTE STRING]</i> . Refine this further by adjusting titles, synonyms, and exclusions. Explain what changed and why.

CANDIDATE OUTREACH

ID	USE CASE	TECHNIQUE BLEND	COPY / PASTE PROMPT TEMPLATE
RP-016	Draft personalized outreach	Context priming + constraints	Act as a senior recruiter. Write a personalized outreach to <i>[CANDIDATE TYPE]</i> for <i>[ROLE]</i> . Under 120 words, human, specific, and respectful. Avoid hype and generic flattery. Profile: <i>[PASTE PROFILE]</i> .
RP-017	Mimic recruiter writing style	Few-shot + constraints	Here are examples of my outreach messages: <i>[PASTE EXAMPLES]</i> . Learn my tone, structure, and warmth. Now write a new message for <i>[ROLE]</i> to this candidate: <i>[PASTE PROFILE]</i> .
RP-019	Write 3-touch follow-up sequence	Prompt chaining + audience setting	Create a 3-touch follow-up sequence for <i>[ROLE]</i> . First write a short no-response follow-up. Then a value-add message. Finally a graceful close-the-loop note.

DEBRIEF, OFFER & RESPONSIBLE AI

ID	USE CASE	TECHNIQUE BLEND	COPY / PASTE PROMPT TEMPLATE
RP-031	Summarize interview feedback	Context priming + constraints	Act as a recruiting partner. Summarize feedback for <i>[CANDIDATE]</i> . Separate evidence, concerns, unresolved questions, and next steps. Keep tone

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			neutral and evidence-based. Feedback: <i>[PASTE NOTES]</i> .
RP-036	Create offer closing strategy	Persona fusion + self-consistency	Act as both a recruiter and the candidate. Create a closing strategy for <i>[CANDIDATE]</i> . Consider compensation, career growth, manager fit, company risk, timing, and competing opportunities. Address all concerns truthfully.
RP-072	Review AI output before use	Output structure + constraints	Create a human review checklist for this AI output: <i>[PASTE OUTPUT]</i> . Check for accuracy, bias, unsupported claims, tone, confidentiality, and business usefulness before I use it.

FULL PLAYBOOK COVERAGE — 75 PROMPTS ACROSS 10 STAGES

Role Intake & Calibration · JD Review · Sourcing Strategy · Candidate Outreach · Screening & Fit · Interview Design · Debrief & Decision Support · Offer & Closing · Candidate Experience · Stakeholder Management · Recruiting Metrics · DEI · Recruiter Productivity · Career Development · Responsible AI Governance

"The recruiters who learn to direct AI will have more time for the work that actually requires a human: trust, influence, judgment, and care."

— Mathangi Sivasubramanian, Prompt Engineering for Recruiters

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Core prompting techniques with cue words and TA examples

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Full recruiting lifecycle use cases with real prompt examples

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Reusable prompt templates across the TA workflow

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Day structured learning plan to build lasting prompt fluency

